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Weekly exercises

One exercise per lesson, set at the end of it and worked before the next one. Each lives with its lesson, in `Lessons/NN_topic/Exercises/`.

Nothing is handed in, and nothing is marked week by week. The lesson that follows opens by discussing the exercise, and that discussion is where the answer comes from. They are assessed all the same, once: at the exam, **one of the ten is drawn** and you talk through your own notebook for it. So keep all ten.

That is the whole reason they are never optional. An exercise you skipped is one you may be asked to discuss with nothing to say, and an exercise someone else wrote for you is worse, because you will be asked why you did what you did.

They are deliberately small: two to three hours for a student who attended the lesson. The point is regular contact with the material, not a second project.

Standard format

Every exercise states:

- **Goal** — what you will be able to do afterwards
- **Dataset** — named, with the exact loading snippet. Never “use your own data”
- **Tasks** — numbered and unambiguous
- **What to produce** — a notebook named `exerciseNN.ipynb`, kept until the exam
- **Assessment criteria** — with weights

Common assessment criteria

These describe what the discussion asks of you, at the start of the next lesson and again at the exam. They are not a marking scheme applied to a submission.

Criterion	Weight
Methodological correctness	40%
Implementation	30%
Interpretation and communication	30%

As with the project, **methodology outweighs results**. An exercise that reaches a modest number by a sound route scores better than one that reaches a good number by an unsound one.

How they build towards the project

The exercises are not independent. Taken in order they walk through the same sequence the project demands, one step at a time:

Lessons	What the exercises establish
1-2	Frame a problem; explore and prepare a dataset
3-4	Fit and evaluate a first model; choose a metric that fits the problem
5	Design an evaluation before modelling — the pivot of the course
6-7	Compare model families fairly
8-9	Handle unlabelled data; train a network
10	Diagnose a failing model

By Lesson 5 you should be able to write your project's evaluation plan. By Lesson 7 you should have a draft comparison. The project should not be started in November.

There is nothing to be late for, and no solutions here

Nothing is collected, so there is no deadline to miss and nothing to resubmit. What there is instead is a lesson that opens by discussing the exercise: arrive without having done it and that ten minutes is wasted on you, and the loss shows up at the exam rather than in a mark.

No worked solutions are published, here or anywhere in the repository. The discussion at the start of the next lesson is the solution, and a written one would quietly replace the work the exercise exists to make you do.